

Hey — Sam here. I'll walk you through how the budget system works from both the Admin side and the Participant side, step-by-step, like I'm explaining it to a colleague.

ADMIN: what you do and see

- Where to go:

1. Log in to the Control Center (Admin Portal).
2. Open "Budget & Finance" → "Budgets".
3. You can also open a specific participant record and click the "Create Budget" button there to prefill the participant.

- Create a budget:

- Click "Create Budget".

- Fill the form fields: Participant (pre-filled if launched from a participant page), Quarter Start Date, Quarter End Date, Opening Budget (dollars), Carry Over (dollars).

- Submit the form.

- What happens behind the scenes: a new row is written to the `budgets` table keyed to the `participant\_id` and quarter dates. The app stores money values in cents (e.g., \$1,000 → 100000 cents) and the `BudgetService` computes canonical metrics.

- What you see in the Budgets list:

- Columns: Participant, Quarter (e.g., 2026-07-01 → 2026-09-30), Total Available, Committed, Remaining, Actions (View/Edit).

- "Total Available" = Opening Budget + Carry Over.

- "Committed" = funds currently reserved/committed (pre-approvals, pending invoices, etc.).

- "Remaining" = funds left to be committed/used (Total Available minus any committed/paid amounts).

- View a budget detail:

- Click "View" on a budget row.

- You'll see a ledger: transactions, commits/releases, pre-approvals and invoice history, and derived totals.

- Admins can perform actions: commit funds, release commitments, mark spends as paid, or edit/delete the budget per permissions.

- Who controls the numbers:

- Admin sets the Opening Budget and Carry Over (these establish the quarter's funds).

- Pre-approvals and invoices do not change the opening balance — they change committed/approved/paid metrics.

- `BudgetService` handles calculations and ensures the portal shows consistent canonical metrics.

- Permissions and behavior notes:

- Only users with admin role can see all budgets. Regular users are restricted to their own participant budgets.

- The system uses policies to gate actions (we fixed a role-check issue so policy calls behave correctly).

PARTICIPANT: what they do and see

- Where to go:

1. Log in to the Participant Portal.

2. Open "My Budget" from the sidebar.

- What the participant sees:
 - The same canonical metrics but scoped to the participant: Quarter range, Total Available, Committed, Remaining.
 - A simplified ledger showing pre-approvals and submitted invoices, and whether they're approved/committed/paid.
 - Participants cannot create budgets — admins create budgets for participants.
- Actions available to the participant:
 - Submit pre-approval requests (these may reserve funds by increasing "Committed").
 - Submit invoices against services; invoice approvals update approved/paid metrics and affect remaining balance.
- How to read the numbers (simple example):
 - Admin creates a budget: Opening \$1,000, Carry Over \$200 → Total Available \$1,200.
 - Participant submits a pre-approval that reserves \$100 → Committed \$100, Remaining \$1,100.
 - An invoice for \$100 is marked paid → Paid increases and Remaining decreases accordingly.

EXTRA: common navigation flows

- Admin creates a budget for a participant:
 1. Admin opens Participant → clicks "Create Budget" → form pre-fills participant → submits.
 2. App creates the budget row and redirects back to Budgets list or the created budget page.
 3. Admin sees Total Available in the list (Opening + Carry Over).
- Admin reviews budget usage:
 1. From Budgets list, click "View" → inspect transactions and commitments.
 2. Approve or reject pre-approvals, or mark invoices as paid to update metrics.

TROUBLESHOOTING pointers (short):

- If the Budgets page errors on load, check policy role checks and column names (e.g., ``quarter_start_date`` vs ``quarter_start``).
- If numbers look wrong, confirm that the budget row exists for the correct participant & quarter and that ``BudgetService`` is being used to compute metrics.